PT7004 / PT4052 PRACTICAL:

MSK: Mobility Aids

Date: Tue 05/11/2024 **Time: 15:30 -17:00**

Learning Outcomes:

• Safely assess and prescribe mobility aids, including sticks, crutches, walking frames
• Effectively teach full weight-bearing, partial weightbearing and non-weight-bearing walking and stair climbing with a mobility aid

Session Introduction

1. Why use a mobility aid?
    - Weight bearing (Pain and/or pathology) - patient may be
        - Non-weight bearing (NWB)
        - Touch weight-bearing (TWB)
        - Partial weight bearing (PWB)
        - Full weight bearing (FWB)
    - Balance - ageing, neurological, weakness, obesity
    - Weakness - lower limbs, fatigue
    - Confidence

2. Types of walking aids:
- Crutches:
    - Axillary
    - Elbow
    - Gutter
- Stick:
    - Wooden/Metal
    - Tripod
    - Quadrupod
- Frame:
    - Fixed
    - Wheeled.

3. SAFETY ISSUES

A Walking Aids:

- Check intact structure, Ferrules, Strength, adjustability
- Look for signs of damage: dents, bends, cracks, rusting, erosion of rubber, etc

B Patient

- Medical condition, blood pressure, recent surgery, blood loss, etc
- Cognitive abilities, joint range of motion, muscle strength, balance

C Environment

- Clear of obstacles, dry, flat, may need to adapt walking to environment
- Progress to normal situation

4. Measurement of walking aid to patient:

- Greater trochanter to 2 inches lateral to foot.
- ASIS to lateral malleolus
- ASIS to medial malleolus
- Elbow at 30 degrees flexion, ulnar styloid to floor
- 2 fingers below axilla to lateral border of foot (axillary crutches only)

Additional Reading can be found here: https://livingmadeeasy.org.uk/ (follow the access and mobility link).